(Printed with the demonstration version of Fade In)

TITLE

Written by

Author's Name

Copyright (c) 2025

Draft
information

Contact
information

(Printed with the demonstration version of Fade In)

"Lost Fawn"

Written by

Isa Dagostino

Copyright (c) 2025

(12/12/2025)

Contact information: Marissa.dagos@gmail.com

OVER BLACK.

"Lost Highway" by Kacey Musgraves begins.

MUSIC
And now, here's Kacey Musgraves, takin' us down that old lost highway.

FADE IN:

EXT. ROUTE 40; ARIZONA DESERT - DAYTIME

An old blue chevy pickup comes into focus, drawing closer. After a few seconds, a title card appears beside it: "Lost Fawn".

MUSIC
I'm a rollin' stone, all alone and lost.

INT. TRUCK - day

AMELIE (20) a college junior, wears a baggy t-shirt and loose, ripped jeans. She sits with her fingers clutched tensely around the wheel at ten and two. She stares straight ahead, then glances in the rearview.

MUSIC (cont'd)
For a life of sin, I've paid the cost.

Amelie adjusts the mirror. It shows that the road behind her is empty. She stares ahead again.

MUSIC (cont'd)
When I pass by, all the people say,

The car's gas light comes on, pinging. Amelie smacks the steering wheel with her palm.

AMELIE
(exasperated)
Damn.

MUSIC
(Fades out)
Just another soul on the lost highway.

MUSIC (cont'd)
(Lost Highway instrumental (1:50-2:19) plays)

Amelie swings the wheel left, turning widely into a gas station. Her wheels kick up gravel and dust.

INT. GAS STATION - EVENING

Amelie is in line between a woman and her young daughter. She makes eye contact with the mother, giving a small smile, and watches the little girl reach up to the counter to place some candy there. Amelie then looks away, her smile fading. She places a torn twenty-dollar bill on the counter inside, next to an energy drink.

EXT. GAS STATION - EVENING

The gas station door shuts with the sound of the bell. Amelie walks the pump over and sticks the nozzle in her tank, sagging against the truck. The sun is setting in the desert behind her.

INT. TRUCK - NIGHTTIME

Amelie yawns, spinning the wheel, and pulls into a long driveway.

Amelie breathes out a long sigh. Crickets chirp. MIRA comes out, crossing a robe over her chest. She's a middle-aged woman and appears tired; she is seen through the dashboard.

EXT. TRUCK - NIGHTTIME

Mira walks closer to the car, squinting against the brights. A little dog darts out from the house, barking.

MIRA
(Muffled)
Hey!

INT. TRUCK - NIGHTTIME

Amelie turns the car off.

MUSIC
(Cuts out suddenly with car).

EXT. TRUCK - NIGHTTIME

Amelie opens the car door and leans over its frame to address Mira. The dog runs to her feet and begins sniffing. She pets him.

AMELIE
Hi Petey! Oh, good boy!

She looks up at Mira.

AMELIE (cont'd)
It's late, aunt Mira.

MIRA
I couldn't sleep. Once you're a mom, you'll get it.

Amelie reaches through the driver's side to grab a duffel bag.

AMELIE
(Slightly breathless, teasing)
Uh huh.

MIRA
C'mon. Let's get you settled.

Mira begins to walk back into the house, taking Amelie's duffel bag.

MIRA (cont'd)
(Whistles) Here, Pete!

The dog, Pete, trots behind them, tail wagging.

INT. LAWYER'S OFFICE, THE NEXT DAY - DAYTIME

A lawyer speaks to Amelie, who stands, surveying the papers spread out. She holds a pen. Mira is currently sitting at the desk.

AMELIE
Wait. I... live like, nine hours away. I'm in college, for Christ sake. I can't run an antique store.

She looks over to Mira, desperate.

AMELIE (cont'd)
(Disbelieving)
Aunt Mira, I never even met Tom. Why me, and not you? Or mom?

Mira puts her hand over Amelie's.

MIRA
I don't know, hon. That's between you and your grandda now.

(Beat). Amelie stands up.

AMELIE
Can I have a minute?

De Laurentis nods. Amelie exits.

EXT. LAWYER'S OFFICE - DAYTIME

Amelie holds onto a metal railing. She is bent down with her face resting on her arms. She stays like this for a moment, steadying herself. (Beat).

INT./EXT. LAWYER'S OFFICE

Amelie opens the door. She sits down at De Laurentis' desk again. He finishes drinking from a glass of water and sets it down.

AMELIE (cont'd)
Mr. De Laurentis, what are my options here, realistically?

DE LAURENTIS
Since the business legally belongs to you, if you don't assume its operations, there are a few alternatives.

De Laurentis adjusts his glasses, leafing through paperwork.

DE LAURENTIS (cont'd)
Perhaps leasing, liquidation?

De Laurentis looks at them both, serious.

DE LAURENTIS (cont'd)
Take some time to think about it- I'll give you the deed now. But I'll be here to help once you figure things out.

De Laurentis hands Amelie an orange manila envelope.

MIRA
Thank you.

INT. BARN - LATER - DAYTIME

A beam of sunlight streams through a dusty, streaked window, pooling on the concrete floor. Two muffled thuds occur.

Amelie is moving large wooden furniture pieces, uncovering an old mirror. She sets a desk down with another thud. She wipes her hands on her pants and huffs, looking up.

On the wall is a massive taxidermy deer head, a 9-point buck with beaded eyes.

JOELLE
(Voice)
Hello?

Amelie turns around, startled. Joelle is standing in the barn's entrance.

JOELLE (cont'd)
Wow. This place got even dustier.

AMELIE
Mom?

Joelle smiles tentatively and walks closer. She and Amelie hug, albeit awkwardly. (Beat).

JOELLE
(Unsure of herself)
Mira told me where to find you.

AMELIE
Well, she did call this place a "barn full of crap." I guess she's not sentimental.

JOELLE
(Laughs)
Mira has always hated it in Da's workspace. I think she resented he spent all his time here.

AMELIE
I still don't understand why Tom- (beat) grandad even left me the place.

JOELLE
Maybe he just wanted to connect with you, any way he could.

AMELIE
He could have *called*. It's a moot point now. He's dead.

JOELLE
I- this is all my fault, Bambi.

Joelle hands Amelie a thick stack of envelopes, various colors and sizes. Joelle shifts her eyes to the side, ashamed. Amelie begins to leaf through them.

JOELLE (cont'd)
I was just around your age, and I had you in my belly. I didn't know what to do.

AMELIE
(To herself)
Oh my god.

JOELLE
Tom delivered one of these for you every year on your birthday.

Amelie keeps looking through the letters for a moment, opening a few. She is shocked at first, then slowly becomes more and more upset.

AMELIE
(With tears in her eyes)
This is proof that he *did* love me. You don't get to decide this shit for other people!

JOELLE
(Firm)
He wasn't a bad man, but he was like a ghost, even when he was in my life.

AMELIE
(Resentful)
The first time I ever saw my grandfather's face was in a casket.

Joelle rubs her temples.

JOELLE
Bambi, I-

Amelie cuts her off.

AMELIE
(Bitter)
You missed his funeral, by the way. If that's why you even came.

JOELLE
(Raised voice)
I want to be in your life more, Amelie. I won't alienate you like he alienated me.

Amelie laughs joylessly.

AMELIE
Too damn late.

Amelie grabs the letters, mostly unopened, and storms out of the barn.

INT. TRUCK - DAYTIME

Amelie sits in her truck in Mira's driveway, sobbing against the wheel. The letters are scattered across the passenger seat.

INT. MIRA'S HOUSE - KITCHEN - DAYTIME

Mira places down a steaming mug with a teabag in front of Amelie. Amelie traces the wood grain with her fingertip, eyes puffy.

MIRA
I know this isn't my business.

Mira slides into a chair across from Amelie, with her own cup of tea in hand. LINCOLN, Mira's 3-year old son, comes up to the table, Hotwheel car in hand. He makes "vroom" noises and runs it across the table. Pete the dog follows him, panting. Amelie laughs lightly at the scene.

MIRA (cont'd)
(Gently)
Not now, Link.

Mira gently moves him away, sighing.

MIRA (cont'd)
I was so angry with your mom at first. Once Joelle ran off to raise you, our parents pretty much stopped bothering to parent me. I was alone.

AMELIE
I'm sorry.

MIRA
Don't be. It made me a better mom, that's for sure.

Mira smiles a little and sips her tea. Amelie seems to remember that she also has tea and drinks.

MIRA (cont'd)
You know, she might say something about taking over the business from you.

AMELIE
What? Why?

Amelie stares down at the mug for a moment, thinking. Mira looks equally thoughtful.

AMELIE (cont'd)
What should I say to her?

MIRA
The business is yours now, so do whatever you want. I guess that's kind of the beauty of you being the one to inherit it.

AMELIE
Why does my mom want it so much? To sell it?

MIRA
Closure, or something personal, I imagine. As for the letters... your grandda must have felt guilty about the way things went down.

Amelie sits quietly, then reaches for a napkin. Her elbow knocks her ceramic mug onto the floor. They both flinch at the noise.

AMELIE
(Embarassed)
Oh! I'm so sorry!

Mira comes over with roll of paper towels.

MIRA
Don't worry about it.

She picks up the mug, showing Amelie.

MIRA (cont'd)
Look, it's just chipped. Not broken.

Amelie kneels to sop up the spilled tea. Lincoln playfully screams from the background. Mira gets up.

MIRA (cont'd)
(Over her shoulder)
Can you help me with dinner tonight?

The conversation is unspokenly over. Amelie nods and gets up.

INT. AMELIE'S ROOM - NIGHTTIME

Amelie lays in her bed, staring at the ceiling. (Beat). She then rolls over and closes her eyes. There is a distant heartbeat.

EXT. JOELLE'S HOUSE - DAYTIME

Amelie knocks loudly on the shabby door thrice, to the same rhythm as the heartbeat had been. She waits for a moment, then raises her fist to knock again, when the door swings open to reveal Joelle.

JOELLE
Amelie?

AMELIE
You have one chance to explain. One.

THIS IS NOT THE FULL SCRIPT. PLEASE CONTACT ME TO VIEW MORE!